

UX Report 2: Udemy

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UEQ Shortened Questionnaire

Obstructive	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☒	☐	Supportive
Complicated	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☒	☐	Easy
Inefficient	☐	☐	☐	☐	☒	☐	☐	Efficient
Confusing	☐	☐	☐	☐	☒	☐	☐	Clear
Boring	☐	☐	☐	☐	☒	☐	☐	Exciting
Not interesting	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☒	☐	Interesting
Conventional	☐	☐	☒	☐	☐	☐	☐	Inventive
Usual	☐	☐	☐	☒	☐	☐	☐	Leading edge

Navigation and Category Menu

All of Udemy's main navigation sits in one bar at the top of every page. Explore opens a drop down of broad fields, and hovering over a field opens a second panel of topics inside it. Every row stretches the full width of its panel, so the clickable area is much wider than the text label. Fitts's Law says the time needed to reach a target depends on the distance to it and on its size (Yablonski, 2020). Wide rows make each option easy to hit.

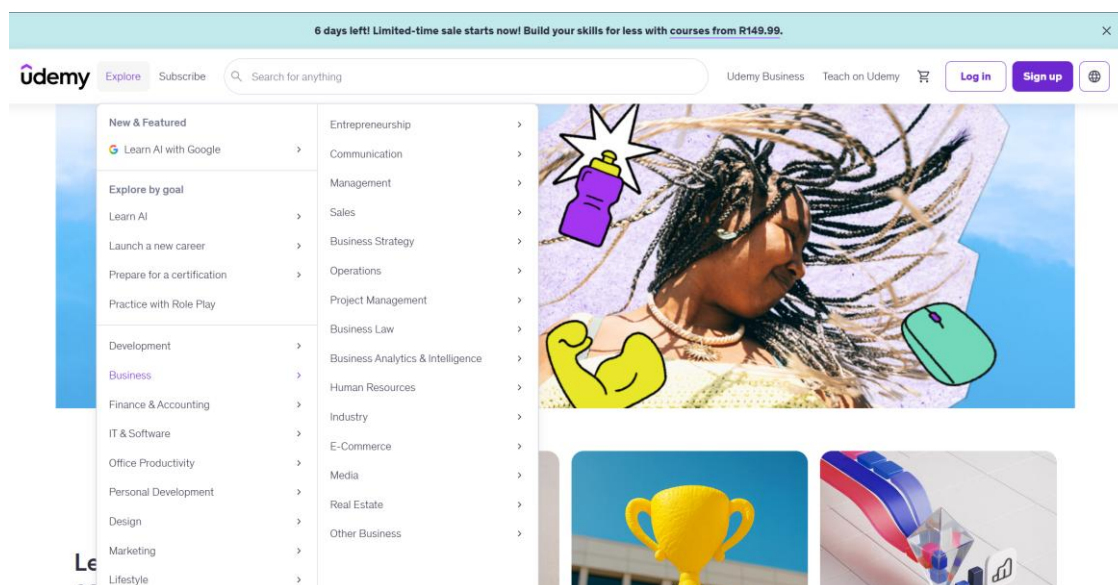


Figure 1: The Explore menu. Each row runs the full width of its panel.

A second bar appears inside a category. On the Sports page, Fitness, Nutrition and Diet, Yoga and other related topics sit side by side under the header. Related choices are close together and well spaced. Therefore, moving between them takes little cursor travel.

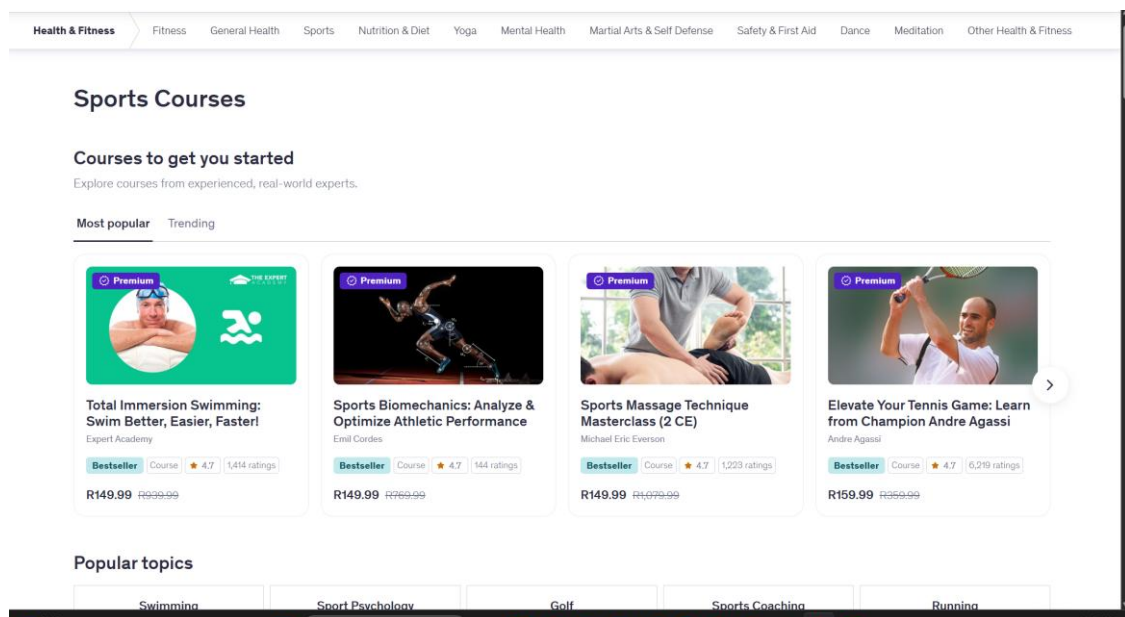


Figure 2: The Sports category page, showing the topic bar, the course cards and the carousel arrow.

Breadcrumbs are the weak point. They use small text with almost no gap between the links, which breaks both the size and the spacing rules that come from Fitts's Law (Lidwell, Holden and Butler, 2010). The search bar is the opposite case since it spans most of the header and is one of the largest targets on the site.

Course Catalogue

Courses appear as cards on the home page and in every category. Each card holds a thumbnail, the title, the instructor, a rating badge and the price. The whole card acts as one link, so clicking the image, the title or the space near the price all open the same course. That gives the user a large block to aim at instead of a thin line of text.

Trending courses

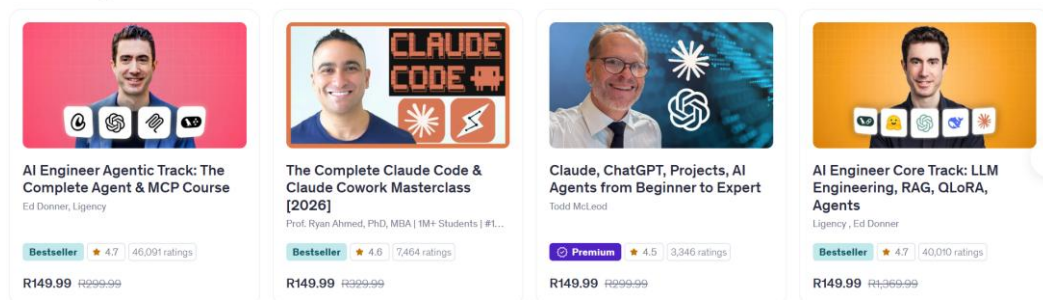


Figure 3: Trending courses. The full card is clickable, but the arrow control is small.

The carousel undoes some of that benefit. Only four courses fit on screen and the rest are reached through a small round arrow that has to be clicked over and over. The Most popular and Trending tabs have a similar issue, since they are plain words with a thin underline and no real button area.

Cards also eat vertical space, so fewer courses show per screen and the user scrolls further. Our client has ruled out cells, and that holds up in usability terms too. A list row spanning the page is a wider target than a card and lets many more courses appear at once.

Course Page

Most of the value on this page sits in the purchase panel on the right. Add to cart and Buy now are stretched to the full width of the panel and stacked with a clear gap between which makes them the two biggest targets on screen. The panel is also sticky, so the distance to the buy button stays the same no matter how far the user scrolls.

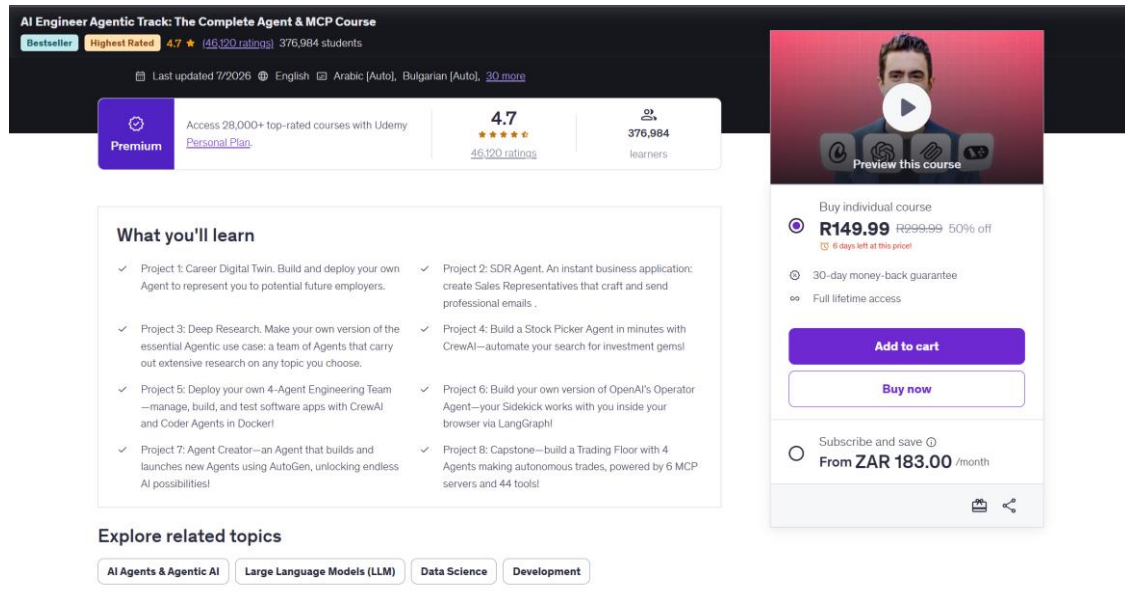


Figure 4: The sticky purchase panel next to the What you'll learn section.

Course content is split into collapsible weeks and each header runs the full width of the container, so the whole row is clickable and not just the small arrow. Expand all sections is less successful because it is a text link pushed to the far right while the headers it controls sit on the left.

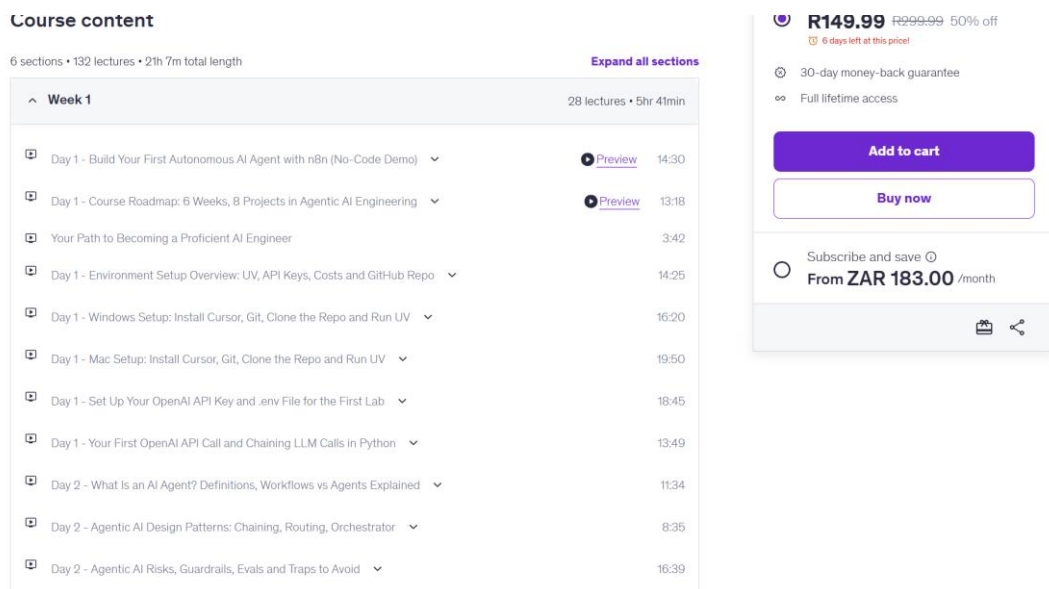


Figure 5: The Course content list. Each section header is a full width target.

Two smaller controls fall short. Subscribe and save uses a small empty circle set apart from its own label, so the user must aim at the circle rather than the whole option. The gift and share icons below it are small and sit close together which makes a wrong click easy.

UEQ Justification

Udemy supported what I set out to do. For that, it scores high on the obstructive to supportive scale. Finding a course, opening it and reaching the buy button took very few steps. Ease of use scored well for the same reason, as the labels use ordinary words and the important buttons are large.

Efficiency and clarity scored lower. Carousels slow the browsing down and a course page is long enough that details such as the difference between buying once and subscribing are easy to miss. The site is still fairly exciting to look at and it holds interest because each card shows the rating and price before you open anything.

Udemy scores lowest on inventive and leading edge. Grids of cards, a sticky checkout panel and accordions are patterns seen everywhere. That is not a flaw on its own since Jakob's Law suggests users prefer a site that behaves like the ones they already know (Yablonski, 2020). It does mean the design feels safe rather than new.

Takeaways for Our Design

- Make the whole list row clickable, not only the title. This keeps the large target Udemy gets from its cards while giving the client the list layout that was asked for.
- Show all results in one scrolling list instead of a carousel.
- Keep the primary action in a panel that stays visible while the page scrolls.
- Give sort and filter controls proper button sizing and group them at the top of the list.
- Where a radio button or checkbox is used, make the label part of the target.
- Leave enough spacing between small controls such as icons and breadcrumbs.

References

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